DAY 27 | PRE-READ

Common Languages for AI

A light read before Day 27. About 15 minutes, no code required.

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Why read this?

As AI agents spread, they need standard ways to connect to tools and to each other. Tomorrow you meet two important standards, and build two advanced patterns: handing work over cleanly, and an agent that analyses data safely.

1. One plug for many devices

Before USB, every printer, mouse and camera had its own cable. USB made one plug work everywhere. The **Model Context Protocol (MCP)** does this for AI: a company exposes its systems once as an MCP server, and any AI application that speaks MCP can use them.

2. Agents talking to agents

Your travel agent calls an airline's booking desk. Each side has its own systems and rules; they agree on how to make and track requests. **Agent-to-Agent (A2A)** is an open protocol for this between AI agents: one agent publishes a card describing what it can do, and others can send it tasks.

Standard	Connects	Everyday comparison
MCP	An AI app to tools and data	Plugging a device into a USB port
A2A	One AI agent to another agent	Your agent phoning another company's agent

3. Handing over well

Nothing frustrates a customer more than repeating their story to every new person. A good handoff, from an AI to a person or between agents, passes a summary, the facts collected and what has been tried.

4. An AI data analyst

Ask "Which city sold the most last month?" and an AI writes the code, runs it and explains the answer. Powerful, and risky: the code must be checked and run somewhere safe, and the answer should show its working so people can verify it.

Key idea: standards make AI easier to connect; safety rules make it safe to connect.

5. Think about these before class

- Which systems at your company would you expose to AI first, and which never?
- Describe a handoff you received that was done badly. What was missing?
- How would you check that an AI's number is correct?

Tsunagu (繋ぐ): to connect